

DESIRE

MOBILE WATCH

Stylish, glamorous and interesting smartphones are always on the horizon. We take a closer look at what's hot in this space...

ReFlex

It's about time that flexible displays go from being mere proof of concept to everyday usable tech. The LG G Flex got so much media attention last year one would think these displays would be commonplace by now. Not so much. Still there's hope: another prototype has appeared and it adds on a few more features. Developed by researchers at the Queen's University in Canada, this phone is surely what can be the phones of the future. The phone has a 720p HD full colour flexible LG OLED display with multi-touch. There are bend sensors and haptic actuators which detect "bend gestures" to receive inputs. Bending it on the left edge for example creates the effect of flipping through pages – something that comes naturally to anyone who's ever leafed through a book. You can feel the sensation of the page moving through the fingertips via a precise vibration coming from the top of the phone. Imagine you are playing Angry Birds and instead of touching the screen, you have to bend it to pull the bird. More you bend, greater is the pull of the slingshot. These are just some of interesting ways in which we'll be able to interact with flexible screens in the future. The researchers believe that fully commercial devices could be available in the market in the next five years. We can hardly wait.



COURTESY: QUEEN'S UNIVERSITY

Archos Diamond 2 Plus

After the success of Archos 50 Diamond, Archos has introduced its newer entrant in its diamond series, the Diamond 2 Plus. Featuring a 5.5-inch 1080p 2.5D screen, it packs a 400ppi IPS screen. It also features a 20 MP Sony sensor rear camera with dual-LED flash, an 8 MP selfie shooter and is powered by a MediaTek MT 6755 Helio P10 SoC with an Octa-core CPU clocked at 2 GHz and a Mali-T860MP2 GPU. You have 4GB of RAM, 64GB of storage, LTE Cat.6 support, a fingerprint sensor on the back, a USB Type-C port, and a 3,000 mAh battery running on Android Marshmallow 6.0. All this weighs at just 130g and is available for only \$229 (roughly ₹16,000).



CAT S60

Designed especially for the engineers, Caterpillar's S60 comes with an inbuilt thermal camera. It's the world's first smartphone to have such a camera. Why? Well, engineers like to see the world through the eyes of Predator! We kid of course. The idea is to let users peer inside structures, electrical panels, vehicles or other enclosures and detect heat sources. It also allows you to see in pitch-black darkness by detecting the heat points. Along with the rugged looks and build, S60 is also waterproof and can withstand drops of up to 5.9 feet on concrete, owing to its die cast frame. Priced at \$599 (roughly ₹42,000), its other specs include a 7-inch HD display with Gorilla Glass 4 protection that also supports touch with wet fingers as well as gloves, a 5MP front-facing camera, 32GB storage and 3GB RAM along with a 3,800 mAh battery and Android Marshmallow 6.0 running under the hood. Phew!